

## **Case Study -**

### **Cybercrime Type: UPI / Online Payment Fraud**

UPI/Online Payment Fraud is a cybercrime in which criminals trick people into sending money or sharing confidential banking details such as OTP, UPI PIN, or payment request approval. This fraud usually happens through fake phone calls, WhatsApp messages, QR codes, or fraudulent payment links.

A common scenario begins when a student receives a message claiming they have won a cashback reward or need to verify a bank account. The fraudster may pretend to be from a bank, customer care service, or online shopping platform. First, the victim is asked to click a fake link or scan a QR code. Next, they are told to enter personal banking details or approve a “receive money” request. In reality, the request is actually for sending money. Sometimes the fraudster creates urgency by saying the account will be blocked if action is not taken immediately.

These scams usually target students, elderly people, online shoppers, and users who are not fully aware of digital payment safety. The consequences can be serious, including financial loss, bank account misuse, emotional stress, and leakage of personal information. In some cases, victims may also lose access to their accounts or become targets of repeated fraud.

This case highlights the importance of verifying payment requests, avoiding unknown links, and never sharing OTP or UPI PIN with anyone.